

FILM DOSSIER: BLACK PANTHER: DOOMWAR

Phase 4 · Film #7 (Saga Two, Film #7 · Overall Film #36)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #7 (Phase 4, Film #7) · MCU #36
Phase	Phase 4, The Secret Wars Saga
Real title	<i>BLACK PANTHER: DOOMWAR</i> (the 616 storyline)
Decoy / codename title	<i>"HEARTLAND"</i>
Release date	Friday, November 3, 2023
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Ryan Coogler
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 162 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + war film / heist / royal succession drama

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	LETITIA WRIGHT. The Black Panther franchise is hers now, in memory of Chadwick Boseman.

Character	Actor	Age at release
Shuri / Black Panther	Letitia Wright	30
Victor von Doom	Robert Downey Jr.	58
Okoye	Danai Gurira	45
Nakia	Lupita Nyong'o	40
M'Baku	Winston Duke	36
Queen Mother Ramonda	Angela Bassett	65
W'Kabi	Daniel Kaluuya	34
Namor (cameo)	Tenoch Huerta	42
Reed Richards / Tony Stark (the Illuminati, cameo)	Pedro Pascal / Marc-Anthony Bullock	48 / 41
T'Challa (archival footage and voice, in memory)	Chadwick Boseman (1976–2020)	–

*In memory: the film opens with archival footage of Chadwick Boseman as T'Challa, and the Marvel Studios logo is silent. The dedication is "For Chadwick. Wakanda Forever."****

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Doomwar</i> #1–6 (2010), Jonathan Maberry & Scot Eaton: Doctor Doom invades Wakanda, takes its vibranium vaults, and plans to fuse vibranium with magic. To stop him, the Black Panther makes every piece of processed vibranium in Wakanda inert , giving up the nation's fortune.
Supporting comics	<i>Black Panther</i> vol. 5 #1–6 (2009), Reginald Hudlin: " The Deadliest of the Species ," in which Shuri is tested by the Panther god Bast, is rejected at first, then chosen · <i>Fantastic Four</i> #52 (1966, vibranium) · Hickman's <i>New Avengers</i> (2013–15): Wakanda at the center of the Incursions
Nerf check	☒ Doom beats Wakanda's army and takes the vaults. Shuri wins by giving up everything, not by overpowering him. Doom leaves undefeated.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	95%. <i>Doomwar</i> and Shuri's 2009 arc are adapted closely.

Straight from the page:

- **Shuri faces Bast's trial. She's rejected at first**, and then **chosen** after proving her heart (*BP* vol. 5 #1–6).
- **Doom invades Wakanda** with the help of a traitor faction (*Doomwar* #1).
- **Doom takes the vibranium vaults** and begins **fusing vibranium with sorcery** (*Doomwar* #2–4).
- **To stop him, the Black Panther makes all of Wakanda's processed vibranium inert**, which **ruins Wakanda's economy** (*Doomwar* #6).
- **Doom escapes** (*Doomwar* #6).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| **Shuri leads the war** instead of T'Challa | On 616, **T'Challa** led *Doomwar* with Shuri beside him. Following real history and the locked showrunner decision, **Shuri is Black Panther**. |

| **Doom's reason** is to **build a machine that can survive the Incursions** | It ties the film into the saga. Doom isn't trying to conquer Wakanda. **He's preparing for the end of everything**. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Shuri / Black Panther	The Heart-Shaped Herb; genius scientist ; Bast's chosen ; later the power of the ancestors (616)	Out-thinks Doom's defenses; makes a nation's vibranium inert with one command	The ghost-walking ancestral powers (616 later)	 100%
Doctor Doom	Genius ; master sorcerer; the Doom armor ; Doombots; fuses magic and technology	Wins every battle, brings Wakanda's army to its knees , and infuses vibranium with sorcery	–	 100%
Okoye / the Dora Milaje	Elite warriors	The defense of the Golden City	–	 100%
M'Baku	Great strength	Leads the Jabari	–	 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	A grieving young queen, not yet sure the gods have chosen her, has to protect Wakanda's heart from the most dangerous man alive, even if it means breaking it herself.
Theme	Grief and sacrifice. Shuri loses her brother, and she's willing to give up Wakanda's wealth to save it.
Villain / antagonist	DOCTOR DOOM

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE PANTHER'S TRIAL

- **Monday, June 12, 2023.** A memorial to **T'Challa** at the Warrior Falls. **Shuri** wears the suit, and **Bast still hasn't spoken to her.**
- **She fails Bast's trial.** The Panther god **turns away.**
- **Queen Mother Ramonda:** *"The gods do not choose us for what we can do. They choose us for what we will give."*

ACT TWO: DOOMWAR

- **Doctor Doom invades Wakanda.** A traitor faction opens the gates. Doombots are in the Golden City.
- **Doom takes the vibranium vaults.** He begins **fusing vibranium with magic**, building **something enormous.**
- Shuri faces Doom, and **he beats her easily:** *"You are a child playing at kingship. Your brother at least understood what a king must do."*
- The **Illuminati** (Tony and Reed) arrive to help. Doom **drives them back.**

ACT THREE: WAKANDA FOREVER

- Shuri understands what Doom is building: **a machine to survive the end of the universe.** He needs **all of Wakanda's vibranium** to do it.
 - **She makes her choice.** In the heart of the vault, Shuri sends a single command through Wakanda's network, and **every piece of processed vibranium in the nation goes inert. Wakanda's fortune is gone**, and so is Doom's machine.
 - Doom stares at the dead metal. Then, for the first time, **he bows his head to her**, one monarch to another: *"A worthy sacrifice. You are a queen after all."* He leaves **undefeated.**
 - Shuri kneels in the empty vault. **Bast speaks**, and **chooses her.**
 - **The final image:** Shuri at T'Challa's tomb. *"Wakanda forever, brother."*
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, June 12, 2023 → Saturday, September 23, 2023.
Where it's set	Wakanda (Birnin Zana, the Warrior Falls, the vibranium vaults, the Jabari lands) (filmed on location in South Africa and Zambia) · Latveria (Castle Doom)
Relative to other films	Five months after <i>The Halls of Hel</i> . It's the first MCU film that puts Doom center stage since <i>Fantastic Four</i> (2013).

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Shuri**, chosen by **Bast**.
- **Wakanda has lost its vibranium wealth**, a nation that has to rebuild.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Wakanda's economy collapses	Its vibranium is inert	Phase 5 (Wakanda and Atlantis at war over resources)
Namor	A cameo: he watches Wakanda's weakness, and smiles	<i>Time Runs Out</i> (Phase 5)

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Doom's machine	<i>"A machine to survive the end of everything."</i>	Doom knows the Incursions will win , and he's preparing to be the last man standing .
The Beyonders	The post-credit scene	<i>The real enemy</i>

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "THE HEART." Deep under the vault, one small piece of raw, unprocessed vibranium glows in the dark. Shuri picks it up, and she smiles.
Post-credit scene	✓ "BEYOND." Castle Doom, at night. Doom studies a recording from his time platform : the moment two Earths collide. Behind the collision, far off at the edge of the image, he sees towering, faceless white figures walking between the universes. DOOM (<i>very quietly</i>): "...So. Someone is doing this on purpose." CUT TO BLACK. "BLACK PANTHER WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " PAPERWEIGHT. " Post-credit: " GHOSTS. "

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline